Admission Requirements

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Admissions requirements are standard throughout the university and applies to all students. Some programs have additional requirements in addition to the base standards. The purpose of the admission process is to identify applicants who are likely to succeed academically at University of the Cumberlands and at the same time contribute positively to the campus community. In making admission decisions the University considers many factors, including high school records (including courses taken, grade trends, and rank in class), standardized test scores, extracurricular activities and honors, and personal contact with the student. In some cases,

a teacher recommendation and an essay may be requested. Scroll down the page for Graduate and Program Specific Admissions Requirements.

Undergraduate Admission Requirements

All Undergraduate Applicants Must Submit

• A completed Application.

• An official high school transcript with the grade point average computed on a 4.0 scale. GED students must provide official scores from the General Education Development Test (GED); Students with 0-11 hours of college credit must submit an official high school transcript showing a cumulative GPA of at least 2.0 on a 4.0 scale. GED students must provide official scores from the General Education Development Test (GED). High school transcripts are not required for students who have obtained 12+ hours of college credit after graduating high school. The admission office will confirm all students' transcripts arrive from a high school with a

CEEB code, as well as the high school seal and/or signature. If a transcript is from a high school that lacks a CEEB code or seal/signature, the admission office will investigate to confirm the school is recognized by the state department of education or home school association. The admission office may request a copy of the student's diploma at any point in the admission process for verification purposes. If a diploma is determined invalid, a GED may be required for admission consideration.

• Official transcripts from relevant colleges/universities attended.

• A student transferring from another University MUST be eligible to return to the college from which you are transferring.

4. Any additional information as requested by the University to determine admission eligibility.

5. All academic credit from an educational institution outside the United States must be evaluated by one of the transcript evaluation services referenced below:

• World Education Services (WES)

• International Education Research Foundation (IERF) Eval Direct

• Educational Perspectives (EP)

• Educational Credential Evaluators (ECE)

• Student-Athletes are encouraged to use PLAYNAIA InCRED

• TEC

Non-native English-speaking applicants are required to demonstrate English proficiency for admission to the university through submission of an official test score or through a virtual interview process with an admissions representative. Minimum test scores that successfully demonstrate English proficiency are listed below:

• ACT - 17

• SAT - 920

• TOEFL (paper-based) - 550

• TOEFL (internet-based) - On January 21, 2026, the TOEFL will update its scoring system to a 1-6 point scale. Currently our standard for admission on the TOEFL exam is a 65. The new equivalent score for our current standard will be a 4.

• IELTS - 6

• DuoLingo - 95

Attended another college or university since last enrollment at University of the Cumberlands (Cumberland College). Candidates for admission as a reentering transfer must submit the following items:

• A completed Application.

• Official transcripts from colleges/universities you have attended.

• Any additional information may be requested by the University.

• High school transcript and/or ACT or SAT scores may be requested.

Reach Out to Us!

Have questions about the admissions or enrollment process? Reach out to a counselor for assistance.

• Email Us

Graduate Admission Requirements

University of the Cumberlands has established qualitative and quantitative requirements for the admission of students whose education preparation evidences the potential for high-level performance. All admissions materials must be received in the Graduate Admissions Office or the Department of International Graduate Services Office (DIGS) Office (for Executive Format program students).

Additional requirements for each program are contained within the School/Department sections.

Academic departments may have varying GPA requirements. Please see the academic department section for specific requirements.

• Completed Graduate Application with payment of required Application Fee.

• Request that official transcripts of undergraduate and graduate work be sent directly from the respective institution(s) to:

University of the Cumberlands Graduate Admissions 6178 College Station Drive Williamsburg, KY 40769 OR

The (DIGS) office for Executive Format Program students:

University of the Cumberlands Department of International Graduate Services 6178 College Station Drive Williamsburg, KY 40769

The transcript(s) must include the degree and date on which it was conferred. All graduate work as verified by official transcripts:

• Master’s degree admission requires a grade point average of at least 2.5* on a 4.0 scale from a bachelors’ degree or higher from a United States Department of Education accredited institution or an institution approved through the International Evaluation firms listed below.

• Doctoral degree admission requires a cumulative grade point average of at least 3.0** on a 4.0 scale from the conferred master's degree as well as in any subsequent graduate study. Admission to a Doctoral degree program requires a master's degree or higher from a United States Department of Education accredited institution in a field related to the doctoral degree of application. For example, application to a Ph.D. in Information Technology would require a master's in Information Technology, Computer Science, Computer Information Systems, or closely related area.

*Conditional admission may be applicable for certain programs for online students.

** Certain programs require a 3.5 GPA for Admission (PhD CES)

Students must be in good standing in order to be admitted into any program.

• If a student has been on probation for more than one semester in an unfinished program at University of the Cumberlands or has been suspended from a program at University of the Cumberlands or any other IHE, the student cannot be admitted into a new program at University of the Cumberlands.

• Graduation from a program in which a student has been on probation causes those probation semesters to be forgiven in a newly admitted program.

Documentation of language fluency for non-native speakers of English, such as a score report from the Test of English as a Foreign Language (TOEFL) or the International English Language Testing System (IELTS). This requirement is waived for students who have completed a bachelor's program in the U.S. or have completed at least nine hours of master's level coursework in the U.S. at regionally accredited institution. The minimum acceptable TOEFL or IELTS scores for admission are:

• TOEFL - On January 21, 2026, the TOEFL will update its scoring system to a 1-6 point scale. Currently our standard for admission on the TOEFL exam is a 65. The new equivalent score for our current standard will be a 4.

• IELTS - 6

• Duolingo-100

Any international coursework completed must have official transcript evaluations completed and submitted to the University by the evaluation firm.

Evaluations MUST include a cumulative GPA and U.S. equivalency for admission. Approved Evaluation Firms are:

• World Education Services (WES)

• American Association of Collegiate Registrars and Admissions Officers (AACRAO),

• Educational Credential Evaluators (ECE)

• International Education Research Foundation (IERF) EvalDirect

• Educational Perspectives (EP)

• TEC

• Incred

*The transcript evaluation requirement is waived for any student who has completed a bachelor's degree in the U.S., or who has completed at least nine hours of master's courses in the U.S. Applicants seeking doctoral admission are required to provide a certified evaluation as proof of a U.S. master's degree equivalency.

Students are expected to maintain good academic standing in holding appropriate GPA levels as outlined elsewhere in the Catalog. If a student has been dismissed from the institution after following the outlined procedures and recommendations for poor Academic standing, the student can be readmitted to the institution through a written appeal to the Academic Standing Committee.

Program Specific Admission Requirements

Graduate programs with admission requirements in addition to the requirements detailed above are available here. Please see the academic catalog for specific details.

Associate's Degree in Nursing (RN)

Admission to the Associate Degree Program

Acceptance for admission may be granted during the Fall or Spring semester with a new cohort being admitted at the beginning of each fall and spring term. Admission into the ADN program is a selective process. Any previous transcripts must be evaluated before admission is final.

Step 1: Get admitted to UC Undergraduate or be a currently enrolled UC Undergraduate student

Step 2: Apply to the ADN (RN) program

• Once admitted to UC Undergraduate, we will send you your ADN application

• Currently enrolled UC Undergraduate students can find their ADN application in OneLogin

Admission requirements for the ADN (RN) program:

• A high school or college (cumulative and UC) GPA of 3.0 on a 4.0 scale. Click here for the GED to GPA calculator.

• Grades of "C" or better in any supporting courses or major requirements.

• At least one course with a grade of B or above of either BIO 243 Introduction to Human Anatomy or BIO 244 Human Physiology.

• In addition to the academic criteria required for admission, applicants must meet the standards written into the Commonwealth of Kentucky Nurse Practice Act. Specifically, the Nurse Practice Act requires that each student is of good moral and ethical character, good mental and physical health, and be academically qualified to fulfill the role and responsibilities of a person licensed to practice as a professional nurse. Applicants for nursing programs should review licensure information posted on the Kentucky Board of Nursing's website , including information for candidates with a history of prior criminal convictions. Criminal convictions

may serve to disqualify a person from participating in required clinical learning experiences. Students must meet all clinical agency placement requirements.

• Documentation of language fluency for non-native speakers of English, such as a score report from the Test of English as a Foreign Language (TOEFL) or the International English Language Testing System (IELTS). The minimum acceptable TOEFL or IELTS scores for admission are: Paper-based TOEFL (PBT): 550 Internet-based TOEFL (IBT): 79 IELTS: 6

• Students must also be able to meet Clinical Requirements. No exemptions will be made to clinical requirement policies.

• TEAS Exam highly encouraged for admission

• Sufficient capacity for observation in academic, clinical, and other medical settings; functional vision, hearing, and tactile sensation sufficient to observe a patient's condition and perform procedures regularly required during a physical examination

• Effective written and verbal communications skills sufficient to both academic and healthcare settings

• Sufficient motor function to carry out movements necessary for patient diagnosis and care; for free movement in patient care and between facilities and buildings in academic and healthcare environments; physical stamina to complete didactic and clinical coursework

• Sufficient intellectual ability to measure, calculate, reason, analyze, and synthesize, in the context of medical problem-solving and patient care

• Sufficient emotional health and stability required for exercising good judgment and promptly completing all academic and patient care responsibilities

• Capacity to develop effective therapeutic relationships and emotional stability and endurance to function under stress.

Business (MBA/MS) Admission Requirements

Applicants that do not possess an undergraduate degree in business can be provided access to academic leveling courses. These academic leveling courses include Principles of Accounting, Economics, Finance, Management, and Marketing, as well as Statistics.

Students wishing to pursue the MBA Accounting concentration should have completed an undergraduate degree in accounting or demonstrate completion of accounting studies equivalent to the degree.

Criminal Justice Admission Requirements

Admission to the Master of Science in Justice Administration program will be based on evidence that the applicant has demonstrated academic proficiency and the capability for success at the graduate level.

Full Admission:

Upon Admission to the Master's in Justice Administration program, new students must participate in and complete an Advising Meeting with the program Director prior to completing the enrollment process.

Education Admission Requirements

Admission to the School of Education:

University of the Cumberlands has established qualitative and quantitative requirements for the admission of candidates whose education preparation evidences the potential for a high-level performance. All admissions materials must be received in the Graduate Admissions Office.

Application Processfor Master of Arts in Teaching(MAT):

• MAT degree admissionrequires a grade point averageof at least 2.75 on a 4.0 scale.

• Submit three letters of recommendation (one from past or present professors and/or professional associates and one from an employer) onthe Disposition Surveyform.

• Completed Background Check.

• MAED, Rank I and administrative certification, or degree admissionrequires a grade point average of at least 3.00 on a 4.0 scale.

• Submit one copy of the Provisional/Valid TeachingCertificate OR Statement of Eligibility

• All applicants must be certified teachersand have an adequate number of years' experience if applicable. (See programrequirements for more information)

• Submit one copy of the appropriate standardized test score sheet perthe candidate's program.

• Submit three letters of recommendation (one from past or present professors and/or professional associates and one from an employer) on the Disposition Surveyform.

• Documentation of Teaching Experience (3 years for all programs other than School Counseling) and/or Administrative Experience (2 years) depending upon the program.

• AdmissionStatus:

Conditional Admittance:

• Candidates who do not have all the paperwork in the Graduate Admissions Office by the third week of the term will be provisionally admitted to the University. Failure to complete the required paperwork by the fourth week will result in a candidate being dropped from all coursework. The candidate may not continue in the program until all paperwork is received.

• Individuals who are admitted into the University without meeting all admissions requirements may take up to 12 hours of coursework but are not officially a part of the Graduate Education Program.

Full Admittance to the University:

Candidates who meet all the above requirements and who have successfully completed the application process may be fully admitted to the university with admission to the Graduate Education Program pending Graduate Education Committee approval.

Full Admittance into Teacher EducationProgram (Certification):

All documents must be on file in the Graduate Admissions Office prior to the beginning of the term. Failure to complete the above requirements will result in a candidate being dropped from all coursework. After notification of acceptance, the candidate will enroll in coursework. An advisor will be assigned by the Graduate Student Success office. All graduate candidates who are beginning a new program must reapply for subsequent programs. A candidate who has just finished a Master's degree, for example, must reapply before beginning a Rank I program.

Master's in Nursing - Family Nurse Practitioner Requirements

Admission to the program:

A baccalaureate degree with a concentration in nursing is required for admission into the graduate program. Entry-level applicants must (i) have graduated from a regionally accredited or state-approved institution of higher education and earned a four-year baccalaureate degree in nursing; and (ii) hold a current and unencumbered Registered Nurse license.

Secondary-track applicants must (i) have attended a postgraduate programat a regionally accredited or state-approved institution of higher education and earned a master's degree in nursing; and (ii) hold a current and unencumbered Registered Nurse license.

All applicants must submit the following information:

• Completed application and $30 application fee.

• Transcripts of all undergraduate and graduate coursework from all colleges and universities attended. A minimum cumulative grade point average (GPA) of 3.0 for all prior coursework is required for full admission.

• Essay: In 500-700 words, please describe your understanding of the role of the MSN prepared nurse, reasons for pursuing the degree, and how obtaining the degree will change your future practice. Also, please address what strengths and weaknesses you will bring to the program and your understanding of online learning.

• Evidence of a current and unencumbered Registered Nurse license

• Completion of a three hour graduate or undergraduate course in statistics with a grade of C or higher.

Students may be admitted into this Master's program on one of two licensure tracks:

• Students with a baccalaureate degree in Nursing are admitted into the 2 Year Entry-Level Track.

• Students who have already earned a master's degree in Nursing in another concentration (ex. Nursing Administration or Nursing Education) may be admitted into the 18 month Secondary Track.

Entry-Level Track (2 Years):

Students who have graduated from a regionally accredited or state-approved institution of higher education with a baccalaureate degree in Nursing would begin the Master of Science in Nursing Family Nurse Practitioner in this track.

This full 48-semester-hour curriculum may be completed in two years and includes online courses and 720 clinical hours (including the final practicum). There are 24 credit hours of didactic courses that are offered in an eight-week, bi-term format. Eighteen credit hours will be offered through blended learning requiring online didactic course work with the addition of onsite clinical practice with a University approved clinical preceptor. The remaining six hours of the curriculum will be completed through the concentrated Clinical Practicum. The master's degree is conferred upon successful completion of all coursework and the Clinical

Practicum.

Secondary Track (1 Year):

Students who have attended a postgraduate program at a regionally-accredited or state-approved institution of higher education and earned a master's degree in nursing with a different concentration (ex. Nursing Administration or Nursing Education) would begin the Master of Science in Nursing Family Nurse Practitioner in Secondary track in order to be eligible to test for Advanced PracticeBoard Certification.

Students will be required to complete the 33 hours of curriculum specific to a Master of Science in Nursing Family Nurse Practitioner concentration: Advanced Pharmacology, Advanced Health Assessment, Advanced Pathophysiology, FNP Advanced PracticeI, II, and III as well as 360 hours of supervised clinical and an additional 360 hours of supervised clinical internship (total of 720 clinical hours for the program). Students will be required to take any course required by University of the Cumberlands that they did not complete successfully at their previous institution. Up to 15 semester hours of transfer credit are permitted from a

regionally-accredited institution of higher education. The 33-hour curriculum includes online courses, 360 hours of supervised clinical, and an additional 360hours of supervised clinical internship (total of 720 clinical hours for the program).

In addition, 100% of the didactic hours of the curriculum can be completed online. The remainder of the curriculum is delivered through completion of the Clinical Practicum requirements utilizing University approved preceptors and clinical sites. The post master's certificate is conferred upon successful completion of all coursework and the ClinicalPracticum.

Doctor of Physical Therapy Admission Requirements

To qualify for the program, you must meet or exceed the following criteria:

1. Earn a bachelor's degree from a regionally accredited college or university, with a cumulative grade point average (GPA) of 2.75 or higher on a 4.0 scale.

2. Successfully complete the following prerequisite courses in biological sciences, physical sciences, behavioral sciences, and statistics. A minimum cumulative GPA for prerequisites of 3.0 or higher on a 4.0 scale is required. In addition, a grade of C or better in each prerequisite course is required. Prerequisite courses must be completed within ten years prior to admission.

• General Biology 1 and 2 with laboratory (6 semester hours or equivalent)

• General Chemistry 1 and 2 with laboratory (6 semester hours or equivalent)

• General Physics 1 and 2 with laboratory (6 semester hours or equivalent)

• Human Anatomy and Physiology 1 and 2 with laboratory (6 semester hours or equivalent)

• Statistics (3 semester hours or equivalent)

• General Psychology (3 semester hours or equivalent)

• A minimum of one 3 semester hour or equivalent writing intensive course in humanities or social sciences

• Completion of a medical terminology course – this can be completed for credit at a college or university or proof of completion of an online certification course.

Physical therapy education and practice requires a strong science background. Additional upper-level Biology or Health Science courses (embryology, advanced physiology, genetics, etc.) are recommended.

3. Complete twenty hours (20) of observation or employment in a physical therapy setting under the supervision of a licensed physical therapist and verified by the physical therapist. The purpose of observation hours is to help the applicant develop a basic understanding/knowledge of the PT profession before committing to the rigorous process of obtaining a Doctor of Physical Therapy degree. Observation hours may be completed in outpatient and/or inpatient settings.

4. Submit three letters of reference from professionals who are familiar with your personal and professional characteristics and can best address your potential for success in the DPT program. One letter should come from a college/university faculty member or advisor: one from a licensed physical therapist, and one from an employer or an advisor for an organization.

5. Demonstrate English Fluency. All applicants for whom English is not their first language, or those who completed a bachelor's degree and prerequisites from a college or university in a foreign country, must achieve satisfactory scores on the Test of English as a Foreign Language (TOEFL) or the International English Language Testing System (IELTS), or complete an approved English as a Second Language (ESL) course with the past five years.

Any international course work completed must have official transcript evaluations completed and submitted to the University by the evaluation firm. Evaluations MUST include GPA for admission. Approved Evaluation Firms are:

• World Education Services (WES)

• Educational Credential Evaluators (ECE)

• International Education Research Foundation (IERF)

• Educational Perspectives (EP)

• SpanTran

6. Demonstrate an ability to meet Program Technical Standards

A candidate must have abilities and skills in five areas:

• observation,

• communication,

• motor/psychomotor,

• cognitive (intellectual, conceptual, integrative, and quantitative), and

• behavioral and social.

Technological compensation can be made for some limitation in certain of these areas, but a candidate should be able to perform in a reasonably independent manner.

Candidates are required to certify that they understand and meet program Technical Standards. Candidates must provide such certification prior to matriculation. Candidates who may not meet the Technical Standards must inform the Director of Admissions, who will then contact the Dean of Students. The Dean of Students, in consultation with the academic dean (and program director), will identify and discuss what accommodations, if any, the College(/Program) would need to make that would allow the candidate to complete the curriculum. The College(/Program) is not able to grant accommodations that alter the educational standards of the curriculum.

Students must meet the Technical Standards for the duration of enrollment in their professional program.

The Doctor of Physical Therapy program is a six semester, 24 month, 115 credit hour program. During the first full year of Cumberlands' DPT program, students will participate in online classes and early integrated clinical experiences and will attend intensive lab immersions held on Cumberlands' main campus in Williamsburg, Kentucky. During the second year of the program, students will participate in online classes, on-campus lab immersions, and three full-time clinical experiences. Full-time clinical experiences will be held throughout Kentucky and across the United States.

Physician Assistant Admission Requirements- Williamsburg Campus

All applicants must submit the following information:

• Completed CASPA application

• Completed PA Supplemental application

• An earned bachelor’s degree with an overall minimum cumulative grade-point average (GPA) of 3.0 on a scale of 4.0

• Main Campus: A minimum average of 3.0 on a scale of 4.0 in required pre-requisite courses with a minimum of a C in all prerequisite courses.

• Main Campus: A minimum of 3.0 average on a 4.0 scale in the sciences as figured by Central Application Service for Physician Assistants (CASPA)

• Main Campus: A minimum of 3.0 GPA on a 4.0 scale in the combined Biology, Chemistry, Physics (BCP) as figured by the Central Application Service for Physician Assistants (CASPA).

• Ability to fulfill any university admission requirements.

• Successful completion, with a minimum letter grade of “C” or better, within ten years prior to admission of the following undergraduate or graduate prerequisite courses:

• Anatomy with lab (Human required at NKY campus; Human preferred at Main campus) - 3 semester hours or more.

• Physiology with lab (Human required at NKY campus; Human preferred at Main campus) -3 semester hours or more.

• Microbiology with lab - 3 semester hours or more

• Medical Terminology

• Biology electives- 6 c redit h ours (Must be upper-level Biology courses, highly recommend genetics, molecular biology, histology, immunology)

• General Chemistry 1 and 2 with labs- 3 semester hours or more

• Organic 1 orBiochemistry

• Psychology (Abnormal or Developmental preferred)- 3 semester hours or more

• Statistics- 3 semester hours or more

• Direct Patient Contact Hours (minimum of 500 hours of paid employment or volunteer hours; must include a minimum of 50 hours PA shadowing)

• Submission of 3 letters of recommendation (Acceptable references: MD, DO, PA, or NP as well as academic advisors)

• Successful completion of an interview with and positive recommendation from program faculty

Physician Assistant Admission Requirements- NKY Campus

All applicants must submit the following information:

• Completed CASPA application

• Completed PA Supplemental Application

• Documentation of language fluency for non-native speakers of English, such as a score report from the Test of English as a Foreign Language (TOEFL), the 8 International English Language Testing System (IELTS), or a report from Duolingo. This requirement is waived for students who have completed bachelor’s or master’s level coursework in the U.S. at an accredited institution.

• An earned bachelor’s degree with an overall minimum cumulative grade-point average (GPA) of 3.0 on a 4.0 scale

• A minimum Biology-Chemistry-Physics (BCP) GPA average of 3.0 on a 4.0 scale calculated by Central Application Service for Physician Assistants (CASPA)

• Ability to fulfill any university admission requirements.

• A minimum letter grade of “C” or better, within ten years prior to admission of the following undergraduate or graduate courses:

• Human Anatomy with lab - 3 semester hours or more

• Human Physiology with lab - 3 semester hours or more

• Microbiology with lab - 3 semester hours or more

• Medical Terminology

• Biology electives - 6 c redit h ours (Must be upper-level Biology courses; highly recommend Genetics, Molecular Biology,Histology, Immunology)

• General Chemistry 1 and 2 with labs -3 semester hours or more

• Organic 1 orBiochemistry

• Psychology (Abnormal or Developmental preferred) - 3 semester hours or more

• Statistics - 3 semester hours or more

• Direct Patient Contact Hours (minimum of 500 hours of paid employment or volunteer hours; must include a minimum of 50 hours PA shadowing)

• Submission of 3 letters of recommendation with at least one from a physician (MD/DO) or PA

• Successful completion of an interview with and positive recommendation from program faculty

Master of Arts in Clinical Mental Health Counseling Requirements

The following items are necessary for admission to the Master of Arts in Clinical Mental Health Counseling program:

• Completed Graduate Application and payment of the associated fee

• A completed Bachelor's degree with a minimum cumulative grade point average (GPA) of 3.0 on a 4.0 scale *A 2.5 to 2.9 GPA could be considered for review if the additional essay prompt is completed with the associated Writing Sample

• Submit official transcripts from all applicable colleges/universities attended; must be received directly from the issuing college or university.

• Writing Sample Prompt

• Documentation of language fluency for non-native speakers of English, such as a score report from the Test of English as a Foreign Language (TOEFL), the 8 International English Language Testing System (IELTS), or a report from Duolingo. This requirement is waived for students who have completed bachelor's or master's level coursework in the U.S. at an accredited institution. The minimum acceptable TOEFL or IELTS scores for admission are: Paper-based TOEFL (PBT) - 550 Internet-based TOEFL (IBT) - 79 IELTS - 6 Duolingo - 100

• Any international coursework completed must have official transcript evaluations completed and submitted to the University by the evaluation firm. Evaluations MUST include GPA for admission. Approved Evaluation Firms are: World Education Services (WES) Educational Credential Evaluators (ECE) International Education Research Foundation (IERF) Educational Perspectives (EP) SpanTran

• Submit two Letters of Reference from individuals commenting on the applicants academic and professional potential. *Letters of reference from family/friends will not be accepted.

All admissions materials should be submitted to Graduate Admissions:

University of the Cumberlands Graduate & Online Admissions 649 S. 10th Street Suite C Williamsburg, KY 40769

Phone 606.539.4390 Toll Free 800.343.1609 Email gradadm [at] ucumberlands.edu (gradadm[at]ucumberlands[dot]edu)

Previous Education Requirements

Completed bachelor's degree from a regionally accredited college showing a GPA of 3.0 on a 4.0 scale.

Transfer of Credit Policy

The Online Master's in Clinical Mental Health Counseling Degree Program requires completion of 60 hours of graduate level work. This is also a requirement for licensure as a Professional Counselor in most states.

A maximum of eighteen credit hours of credit may be transferred from a regionally-accredited institution of higher learning. These transfer credits must be in courses determined to be equivalent to courses required in the program. All transfer credits must be approved by the Program Director and the Registrar.

PhD in Counselor Education & Supervision Admission Requirements

Responsibility for the routine administration of the policies and procedures of the program resides with the Program Director or Dean for School of Social and Behavioral Sciences under the oversight of the Vice President for Academic Affairs.

To be considered for full admission into the Ph.D. in Counselor Education and Supervision program, prospective students must:

• Hold a 60-credit hour CACREP (or equivalent) master's degree in counseling. All CACREP entry-level core and specialty area requirements must be met for full admission in the CES program.

• Submit official transcripts from all applicable colleges/universities attended; must be received directly from the issuing college or university.

• Have a minimum cumulative 3.5 GPA (on a 4-point scale) on all graduate work as verified by official transcripts.

• Admission into this program requires a satisfactory score on the National Counselor Examination (NCE).

• Hold a current professional counseling license in the state of practice.

• Two recommendations from professional sources (supervisors, employers, professors).

• Provide a writing sample detailing the applicant’s contribution to the counseling profession, professional goals for the future, and research interests.

• Provide a current resume’ or CV.

• Documentation of language fluency for non-native speakers of English, such as a score report from the Test of English as a Foreign Language (TOEFL), the 8 International English Language Testing System (IELTS), or a report from Duolingo.

• Any international course work completed must have official transcript evaluations completed and submitted to the University by the evaluation firm. Evaluations MUST include GPA for admission.

• Successfully complete admissions interview with the admission committee.

All admissions materials should be submitted to Graduate Admissions:

University of the Cumberlands Graduate & Online Admissions 649 S. 10th Street Suite C Williamsburg, KY 40769

Phone 606.539.4390 Toll Free 800.343.1609 Email gradadm [at] ucumberlands.edu (gradadm[at]ucumberlands[dot]edu)

Based upon an assessment of all information provided by prospective candidates, admission will be granted to the limited number of places available in a given cohort.

Occupational Therapy Doctorate Admissions Requirements

The program is delivered in a blended format that combines online learning with hands-on, on-campus experiences — making doctoral education accessible to students wherever they are. Coursework integrates both asynchronous and synchronous distance learning alongside intensive immersive labs held each semester at our state-of-the-art facilities in Williamsburg, KY. These 12–14 day on-campus sessions give students the face-to-face, hands-on training essential to occupational therapy practice.

The OTD program at the University of the Cumberlands will use a holistic admissions process and offer two pathways for entry into the OTD program.

Direct Entry for Admission

Applicants who have earned a minimum of a bachelor's degree from a United States Department of Education-accredited institution, or an institution approved through the International Evaluation firms listed below, are eligible to apply through the direct entry pathway.

• A minimum overall GPA of 3.0 (on a 4.0 scale) is required. A minimum overall GPA of 3.0 on a 4.0 scale) on prerequisite coursework with a grade of B- or better in each course Applicants with an overall GPA between 2.75 and 3.0 may be considered for admission, pending a case-by-case review by the Admissions Committee to determine suitability for the program.

Accelerated Pathway for Admission

• Applicants must complete a minimum of 90 undergraduate semester credits (or equivalent quarter hours) prior to matriculation into the occupational therapy doctorate program. Thirty graduate semester credits from the first year of the occupational therapy doctorate program may be applied towards the completion of a bachelor’s degree A minimum overall GPA of 3.0 (on a 4.0 scale) and a GPA of 3.0 (on a 4.0 scale) in the last two semesters of undergraduate is required. A minimum overall GPA of 3.0 on a 4.0 scale) on prerequisite coursework with a grade of B- or better in each course Applicants with an overall GPA between 2.75 and 3.0 may be

considered for admission, pending a case-by-case review by the Admissions Committee to determine suitability for the program.

Other Requirements

In addition, all applicants must complete the following requirements prior to matriculation into the occupational therapy doctorate program:

• A 4-credit course in Human Anatomy or Human Anatomy and Physiology I with lab A 3-credit course in Psychopathology or Abnormal Psychology A 3-credit course in Developmental Psychology A 3-credit course in Statistics A 3-credit course in social sciences (e.g., sociology, anthropology) Two 3-credit courses in basic sciences (e.g., mathematics, physics, chemistry) A minimum of 6 credits in English or Communication must include a writing component

• Official transcripts from all attended institutions must be submitted to OTCAS A minimum of 20 documented observation hours in an occupational therapy setting is required.

• It is strongly recommended that applicants gain experience in multiple practice areas and/or with diverse populations.

• All observation hours must be documented using the program's signed observation forms submitted at the time of application.

• A licensed occupational therapist must sign all forms.

• Applicants must submit two letters of recommendation from professional or academic references discussing applicants’ academic abilities, interpersonal and communication skills, work ethic, and commitment to the occupational therapy profession. Recommendation letters from family or friends will not meet this requirement.

Graduation Requirements

To graduate from the Occupational Therapy Doctoral Program, a student must be in good academic and professional standing and must meet the following criteria

• Complete the required 120 semester credits of didactic and experiential education coursework

• Achieve a letter grade of C or better in all didactic courses

• Maintain a cumulative GPA of 3.00 or above

• Complete all Level I and Level II fieldwork experiences successfully

• Complete the Doctoral Capstone experience and Capstone Project successfully

• Provide documentation of the Capstone Project dissemination and deliverable submission, verified by both the site and the Capstone Advisor

• Complete the OCTH 986 Professional Competency II course successfully

• Submit the required University of the Cumberlands and OTD Program documents in preparation for graduation

• Fulfill all professional and financial obligations to UC as published in the Graduate Catalog , UC Student Handbook , OTD Program Handbook , and as specified in any written communications from the University.

Students can find additional graduation and commencement information in the current Graduate Catalog .

International Students

For any coursework completed at non-US institutions, the applicant must submit an international credential course-by-course evaluation. The Admissions Committee will review the credential evaluation report to determine whether the applicant meets the academic requirements. Credential evaluation can be completed from any of the following international credential evaluation agencies.

• World Education Services (WES) Educational Credential Evaluators (ECE) International Education Research Foundation (IERF) American Association of Collegiate Registrars and Admissions Officers (AACRAO) Educational Perspectives (EP) SpanTran InCred

• International students who completed undergraduate coursework from countries where English is not the first language must demonstrate fluency in reading, writing, and spoken English. This requirement can be satisfied by submitting one of the following. Scores must be official and sent directly from the testing agency A minimum score of 100 on the Internet-based TOEFL (iBT) A minimum score of 7.0 on the International English Language Testing System (IELTS). A minimum score of 130 on the Duolingo English Test

Reach out to us!

Have questions about the admissions or enrollment process? Reach out to a counselor for assistance.

• Email Us